Although first-hand documentation of the *minar* at Da Qadi must await the region's (and Afghanistan's) greater accessibility, David Thomas and his colleagues have analyzed the tower as far as possible through photographs, combining their observations with the requisite input of local villagers with knowledge of the structure, its surroundings, and other historical remains in the vicinity.[66] Understandably, the authors were reluctant to assign a definitive date to the tower, owing not only to the current impossibility of rigorous excavation or direct study at the site, but also due to the absence of epigraphic fragments on or around the remains that could stylistically hint at chronology. Generally speaking, Thomas and his collaborators related the *minar*'s surviving decorative iconography and style principally to Saljuq-patronized towers in the Persianate expanse dating to the first half of the twelfth century.[67]

As described earlier in this chapter, the Da Qadi *minar* shows stark differences with central–southern Ghur's reused and repurposed architectural remains, the two broad types of structures subscribing to distinct architectural cultures. Ghur's stone-footed, brick and plaster ruins hearkened to the late Sasanian–early Islamic presences in the region during the seventh–tenth centuries. Meanwhile, the Da Qadi *minar*, made of baked brick with some additions of wood and clay for structural integrity, ensued from very different building practices: this *minar* and related parallels formed an essential typology within an architectural culture initially fomented by Saljuq patronage,[68] which eventually became the transregional and cosmopolitan architectural language adopted by imperial formations of the eleventh–twelfth centuries throughout the Persianate world.

The dissemination of cosmopolitan Persianate building practices in southern Afghanistan appears to have occurred certainly by the beginning of the eleventh century, and possibly before. Saljuq *minar*s surely served as aspirational impetuses for Ghaznavid towers, the surviving examples having been attributed to Mas'ud III (r. 1099–1114) and Bahram Shah (r. 1118–1152), now the most prominent remnants of Ghazna's once magnificent *urbs* (Figure 2.25). The Ghaznavid *minar*s' stellate – rather than cylindrical – plans *formally* evoke the remnants of Buddhism in their vicinity, as well as two known towers from central Sistan: one at Zaranj-Nad-i Ali (Figure 2.26); the other, known as Khwaja Siyah Push (Figure 2.27), near Chakhansur (north and northeast of Qasimabad, respectively). These towers' plans combined pointed and semi-circular flanges, and have also been cited as precedents for Delhi's Quṭb Minar (founded *c.*1199 CE).[69] The early Shansabanis would not have had to look impossibly far, then, for workers specialized in brick construction, whose skills would have been required for building the *minar* at Da Qadi: several such towers were already standing in the contiguous regions of Sistan (Figure 2.18)[70] and Zabulistan (specifically Ghazna) (Figure 2.25), as well as farther afield at prominent emporia like Balkh (Figure 2.19).